

View of the rings

Our view of Saturn's rings changes as it orbits the Sun. Every 15 years, Saturn is sideways to us and the rings seem to disappear.



Sometimes we get an excellent view of the rings.



Our sideways view of Saturn



Sometimes we can see the underside of the rings.



Close-up

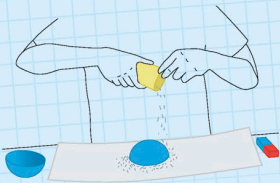
Some of Saturn's rings are made of small pieces that are like icy dust. Other rings contain big, car-sized boulders.

MAGNETIC PLANETS

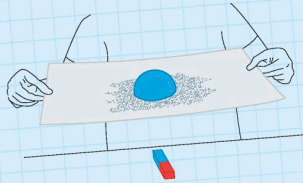
Some planets are giant magnets, with a force that stretches into space. Use iron filings, a magnet, thin cardboard, and half a plastic ball to show the magnetic force around a planet.



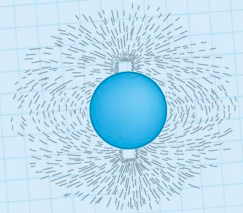
Be careful with the iron filings—don't inhale them or get them in your eyes.



1. Place the half-ball on the cardboard. Scatter a fine layer of iron filings over the ball.



2. Carefully lift the cardboard and place it over the magnet. Tap it lightly. The iron filings will form a pattern of lines around the ball.



3. You'll see the lines curve outward. Some planets have lines of magnetic force around them. The lines come from the planets' north and south poles.